

EAST AFRICAN COMMUNITY TRADE & ECONOMIC INTEGRATION

Project title: Analysis of Trade, Economic Performance and Regional Integration among EAC Partner States (2015–2024)

Objectives

The study seeks to:

- Analyse the demographic and economic characteristics of the EAC Partner States.
- Examine trends in intra-EAC trade and trade with the rest of the world.
- Compare macroeconomic indicators such as GDP, GDP growth, inflation, population, and trade balances across Partner States.
- Identify the major exports and imports of each Partner State.
- Assess the progress of regional economic integration under the Customs Union, Common Market, Monetary Union, and Political Federation.
- Identify challenges affecting regional economic integration.
- Provide policy recommendations for strengthening economic cooperation and trade within the EAC.

Research Questions

The study seeks to answer the following questions:

1. Which EAC Partner State contributes the largest share of regional GDP?
2. Which countries record the highest levels of exports and imports?
3. How has intra-EAC trade evolved between 2015 and 2024?
4. Which commodities dominate regional trade?
5. Which Partner States record trade surpluses or trade deficits?
6. What are the major drivers of economic growth within the EAC?
7. What challenges hinder regional economic integration?
8. What policy measures can strengthen trade and economic cooperation within the EAC?